Gulshan Mastonova

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CIVIC ANALYTICS GRADUATE | DATA & PUBLIC POLICY RESEARCH
Using Research and Data to Support Community, Infrastructure, and Policy Decisions

Graduate student in MS in Civic Analytics with a strong academic background in global economics and applied research, economic development, and program support. Experienced in public-sector research, municipal data collection, and policy analysis. Skilled in collecting, organizing, and preparing qualitative and quantitative data from government sources, including municipal documents, and financial reports. Experienced in supporting research projects related to water infrastructure, public finance, and economic development. Proficient in Excel and working knowledge of R. Detail-oriented researcher with strong communication skills and the ability to work independently and collaboratively on complex public-sector projects.

COMPETENCIES

- Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Publisher, Outlook)
- Research and policy analysis
- Data collection and management
- Teamwork and leadership skills
- Analytical thinker
- Attention to details
- Technical writing
- Time management
- Result–oriented

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Chicago (UIC) **2024 - present**
Master of Science in Civic Analytics *Chicago, IL, USA*
University of Central Asia (UCA) **2017 - 2022**
Bachelor of Arts in Global Economics *Khorog, Tajikistan*

WORK EXPERIENCE

Government Finance Research Center, UIC **remote, Chicago, IL**
Graduate Hourly Position *06/2025 – 05/2026*
- Contribute to research project analyzing water systems, sewer, and metering practices across the state to inform policy making.
- Code qualitative data from municipal ordinances to support GFRC's analysis of drinking water infrastructure and policy needs in Cook County.
- Assist the Department of Commerce & Economic Opportunity (DCEO) in evaluating competitive grant applications under the Small Business Capital and Infrastructure Grant program.

Aga Khan Health Service **Khorog, Tajikistan**
Communication Coordinator *05/2024 – 09/2024*
- Develop comprehensive communication strategies to effectively convey the organization's objectives to internal and external audiences.
- Create engaging content for websites, social media platforms, newsletters, press releases, and marketing materials.
- Contribute to the development of and realization of the AKHS Strategy Action Plan, budget papers, and concept papers.

UNICEF **Dushanbe, Tajikistan**
Health and Nutrition Intern *10/2023 – 04/2024*
- Support the team with programme implementation, including preparing and monitoring of training activities.
- Assist knowledge management for the programme including entering data and information into Activity Info database.

• Help to organize meetings including taking responsibility for the finalization of meeting agenda and invitations.

Aga Khan Foundation Geneva (AKDN) **Khorog, Tajikistan**
Research Assistant *10/2021 – 08/2022*

- Support the collection, cleaning, and analysis of quantitative and qualitative data to assess multi-dimensional aspects of quality of life in the country.
- Assist in preparing comprehensive reports and visualizations based on field research to inform programmatic decision-making.
- Coordinate with field teams and local partners to ensure accurate data gathering, resolve inconsistencies, and contribute to the integrity of research findings.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

University of Central Asia **Khorog, GBAO**
Mentor of Rushon Orphanage Educational Program *01/2018 – 05/2020*

- Schedule and host a variety of educational clubs for students in 9th to 11th grades, fostering academic enrichment.
- Design the application process and fellowship content; provide guidance and mentorship to candidates throughout the selection and participation phases.
- Organize internal and external workshops, and events, coordinating logistics and ensuring meaningful experiences for participants.

University of Central Asia **Khorog, GBAO**
Team Lead of Children's Play Group *10/2017 – 04/2019*

- Host the "Book Club" by developing engaging content, facilitating weekly discussions, and encouraging critical thinking.
- Design and teach basic English and Math courses, tailoring the curriculum to meet students' learning needs.
- Maintain regular communication with parents, providing updates on their child's academic progress.

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATES

University of Central Asia (UCA) Outstanding Community Service 2022
Khorog, Tajikistan

LANGUAGES (reading, writing, speaking)

English - Advanced
Russian - Upper-Intermediate
Tajik (native language) - Advanced